

D743

Education Portfolio

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A candidate uploads a unit plan to her portfolio. She designed it over winter break in a coffee shop and used a new planning template the district released. Which addition makes it strong evidence of her planning skill?

- A. Four more unit plans with no captions.
- B. A cover page with a photo of the finished plan.
- C. A note that it uses the new district template.
- D. A short caption stating the standard it shows, how students did, and what she would revise.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A draft teaching philosophy reads: 'I believe every child can learn and deserves a safe, caring place.' The candidate has taught in two states and wants a job at a school with a well-known robotics club. Which revision strengthens it most?

- A. Add how that belief looks in practice, such as how she uses daily exit tickets to regroup students who need reteaching.
- B. Add a paragraph praising the school's robotics club.
- C. Cut all beliefs and list only her job history.
- D. Add three more belief statements.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A candidate applying for a middle school science job has 64 files ready for her portfolio. Her supervisor praised her bulletin boards, and the district posting lists four teaching standards it will screen for. What should she do?

- A. Pick artifacts at random to show a range.
- B. Lead with photos of her bulletin boards.
- C. Choose her strongest one or two artifacts for each of the four standards and label the link.
- D. Include all 64 files to show she works hard.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A first-year teacher's mentor asks her to keep a portfolio across the year to show how her questioning improves. She keeps her files on a laptop her aunt gave her. Which kind of portfolio fits?

- A. A résumé listing her questioning workshops.
- B. A process portfolio with dated drafts, videos, and reflections from across the year.
- C. A showcase portfolio of only her best lesson.
- D. A portfolio of her aunt's recommendations.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate's portfolio includes messy early drafts, failed lessons, and notes on what changed. She is about to send it to a hiring principal. What should she change?

- A. Remove all reflections.
- B. Send it as is, since growth is always what principals want.
- C. Add more drafts to show effort.
- D. Build a showcase version with polished best work, keeping a brief growth story if helpful.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

6.

A candidate taught a fraction unit to 25 students. On the pre-test, 5 students met the 80% target; on the post-test, 20 did. Students rated the unit 4.6 out of 5 for fun. What is the best growth statement for her portfolio?

- A. 80% of students met the target.
- B. Students rated the unit 4.6 out of 5.
- C. Students meeting the target rose from 20% to 80%.
- D. Students meeting the target rose by 15%.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A class of 40 had 40% meeting a writing target before a unit. After the unit, 75% met it. How many more students met the target?

- A.** 46
- B.** 30
- C.** 35
- D.** 14

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A candidate wants to include a scanned student essay and a class photo in her public online portfolio. The essay won a school award, and the photo was taken on picture day by a professional photographer. What should she do?

- A.** Post both but blur only the last names.
- B.** Never use student work in any portfolio.
- C.** Remove the student's name and details from the essay and leave out the photo unless written permission and policy allow it.
- D.** Post both, since the essay won an award and is already public.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which version of a student work sample is ready for a public portfolio without extra permission?

- A.** The essay with the name, since the student agreed verbally.
- B.** The essay labeled 'Student A, Grade 5' with name, school, and teacher comments that mention family removed.
- C.** A photo of the student holding the essay, with the name covered.
- D.** The essay with only the first name showing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate writes: 'Today I taught a lesson on the water cycle. Students made posters and we did a song.' Her school is a converted warehouse and her class has two pet fish. What should she add to deepen the reflection?

- A.** A note about the class fish and their role.
- B.** Why it mattered for learning (evidence of understanding) and what she will change next time.
- C.** A fuller description of each poster.
- D.** A rating of the lesson from 1 to 10.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sentence is a Now what statement?

- A.** "Next week I will model one example before group work."
- B.** "The confusion showed they lacked a model."
- C.** "Groups finished in 18 minutes."
- D.** "The lesson was great."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A candidate used a popular song and several images from a published textbook in a class slideshow. She wants to post the slideshow on her public portfolio website, which she built with a free template. Is this allowed?

- A.** Not as is; she should replace the song and images with her own or licensed material, or get permission.
- B.** Yes, since the site template is free.
- C.** Yes, if the song is under 30 seconds.
- D.** Yes, because she used it for teaching.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A candidate uploads a unit plan to her portfolio. ~~She designed it over winter break in a coffee shop and used a new planning template the district released.~~ Which addition makes it strong evidence of her planning skill?

Target word: what makes an entry strong **Decides:** A claim and reflection tied to the artifact.

A	Confusion set	More artifacts without explanation do not show skill.
B	Dropped element	Drops the claim and reflection.
C	Camouflage	Uses the template detail; format does not show planning quality.
D	Correct	Claim plus impact plus next steps turns an artifact into evidence.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A draft teaching philosophy reads: 'I believe every child can learn and deserves a safe, caring place.' ~~The candidate has taught in two states and wants a job at a school with a well-known robotics club.~~ Which revision strengthens it most?

Target word: ground the statement **Decides:** Belief must be shown in practice.

A	Correct	Ties the belief to a concrete, visible practice.
B	Camouflage	Uses the robotics detail; it is about the school, not her teaching.
C	Inverted operation	A philosophy needs beliefs; the fix is to ground them, not remove them.
D	Confusion set	More slogans without examples do not strengthen it.

3. Answer C Concept 3

A candidate applying for a middle school science job has 64 files ready for her portfolio. ~~Her supervisor praised her bulletin boards,~~ and the district posting lists four teaching standards it will screen for. What should she do?

Target word: selection of artifacts **Decides:** Audience screens on four standards.

A	Dropped element	Drops the alignment to standards.
B	Camouflage	Uses the praise detail; displays may not map to the screened standards.
C	Correct	Curating to the audience's standards shows fit clearly.
D	Absolute language	Volume hides the best evidence and ignores the audience.

4. Answer B Concept 4

A first-year teacher's mentor asks her to keep a portfolio across the year to show how her questioning improves. ~~She keeps her files on a laptop her aunt gave her.~~ Which kind of portfolio fits?

Target word: portfolio type **Decides:** Purpose is growth over time.

A	Adjacent category	A résumé lists training, not evidence of change.
B	Correct	Tracking growth over time is the purpose of a process portfolio.
C	Inverted operation	A showcase hides the growth the mentor wants to see.
D	Camouflage	Uses the aunt detail; irrelevant to the purpose.

5. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A candidate's portfolio includes messy early drafts, failed lessons, and notes on what changed. She is about to send it to a hiring principal. What should she change?

Target word: reverse: convert process to showcase **Decides:** Hiring calls for a showcase.

A	Dropped element	Reflection still explains what the work shows.
B	Absolute language	Overstates; hiring needs best evidence first.
C	Inverted operation	Moves further from a showcase.
D	Correct	A hiring audience needs a curated showcase.

6. Answer C Concept 5

A candidate taught a fraction unit to 25 students. On the pre-test, 5 students met the 80% target; on the post-test, 20 did. ~~Students rated the unit 4.6 out of 5 for fun.~~ What is the best growth statement for her portfolio?

Target word: growth figure **Decides:** Percent meeting target, pre vs. post.

A	Dropped element	Drops the pre-test, so growth is not shown.
B	Camouflage	Enjoyment is not learning.
C	Correct	$5 / 25 = 20\%$ and $20 / 25 = 80\%$.
D	Wrong stem number	15 is the change in students, not percent; the change is 60 percentage points.

7. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A class of 40 had 40% meeting a writing target before a unit. After the unit, 75% met it. How many more students met the target?

Target word: solve for number of students **Decides:** Convert each percent to students, then subtract.

A	Inverted operation	Adds the before and after counts ($16 + 30$) instead of subtracting.
B	Dropped element	The after count; it drops the before count.
C	Wrong stem number	35 is the change in percentage points, not students.
D	Correct	40% of $40 = 16$; 75% of $40 = 30$; $30 - 16 = 14$.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A candidate wants to include a scanned student essay and a class photo in her public online portfolio. ~~The essay won a school award, and the photo was taken on picture day by a professional photographer.~~ What should she do?

Target word: privacy in artifacts **Decides:** Public posting of identifiable students.

A	Dropped element	First names and faces still identify students.
B	Absolute language	De-identified work is often allowed and is strong evidence.
C	Correct	Student identities are protected; public posting needs de-identification or permission.
D	Camouflage	An award does not give permission to share it.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

Which version of a student work sample is ready for a public portfolio without extra permission?

Target word: reverse: pick the compliant sample **Decides:** No identifying details remain.

A	Adjacent category	A minor's verbal agreement is not written guardian permission.
B	Correct	All identifying details are removed.
C	Confusion set	A face identifies the student.
D	Dropped element	A first name plus class context can identify a student.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A candidate writes: 'Today I taught a lesson on the water cycle. Students made posters and we did a song.' ~~Her school is a converted warehouse and her class has two pet fish.~~ What should she add to deepen the reflection?

Target word: next reflection move **Decides:** Only the What is present.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail.
B	Correct	Adds the So what and Now what steps.
C	Inverted operation	More description stays at What.
D	Dropped element	Gives a score without meaning or next steps.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

Which sentence is a Now what statement?

Target word: reverse: identify the stage **Decides:** Now what = a future action.

A	Correct	A specific future action is Now what.
B	Adjacent category	Analysis of meaning (So what).
C	Confusion set	Description of what happened (What).
D	Dropped element	Judgment with no action.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A candidate used a popular song and several images from a published textbook in a class slideshow. She wants to post the slideshow on her public portfolio website, ~~which she built with a free template.~~ Is this allowed?

Target word: public posting of copyrighted material **Decides:** Classroom use does not cover public posting.

A	Correct	Public posting goes beyond classroom fair use.
B	Camouflage	The template license does not cover other content.
C	Absolute language	No fixed time rule makes a use fair.
D	Adjacent category	Teaching use in class is not the same as public posting.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	9	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Artifact plus reflection	Each portfolio entry pairs an artifact with a claim about what it shows and a reflection on impact and next steps; the artifact alone proves little.	Uploading many artifacts with no explanation.	“What makes this entry strong evidence?”
2	A grounded philosophy statement	A teaching philosophy names a few core beliefs and shows each one in concrete classroom practice.	Writing broad slogans such as ‘all children can learn’ with no example.	A draft statement full of general ideals.
3	Curating to standards	Select a small set of best artifacts mapped to the professional standards or competencies the audience cares about.	Including everything you have made to look thorough.	A portfolio is long but its purpose is unclear.
4	Showcase vs. process portfolio	A showcase portfolio shows finished best work for an audience; a process (working) portfolio documents growth over time, including drafts.	Using a job-application showcase as a growth record, or the reverse.	The purpose: hiring or evaluation vs. tracking development.
5	Evidence of student learning growth	Show impact with pre/post data on the same skill, reported as gain or percent of students meeting the target.	Reporting only post-test scores or student enjoyment.	Two sets of scores on the same measure.
6	De-identifying student work	Remove names, faces, and identifying details from student work unless you have written permission and it is allowed by policy.	Thinking a first name alone is fine.	Student work samples or photos going into a portfolio.
7	What? So what? Now what?	Reflection moves from describing what happened, to why it matters, to what you will do next.	Stopping at a description of the lesson.	A reflection that only retells events.
8	Copyright in a digital portfolio	Use your own work, licensed material, or material you have permission for; teaching fair use does not cover public online posting.	Assuming anything used in class can be posted publicly.	Published images, songs, or worksheets in a public site.

Course scope (public description): Education Portfolio is an innovative course designed to guide candidates in the creation and development of a comprehensive professional portfolio, specifically tailored for educators. This course emphasizes the importance of documenting and reflecting upon one's educational philosophy, teaching experiences, and professional achievements. Candidates learn how to effectively showcase their skills in curriculum design, classroom management, student assessment, and educational technology. The course also covers strategies for integrating evidence of student learning and feedback into the portfolio. Candidates create a polished and dynamic portfolio that not only highlights their unique educational journey, but also serves as a powerful tool for career advancement and lifelong learning in the field of education.